



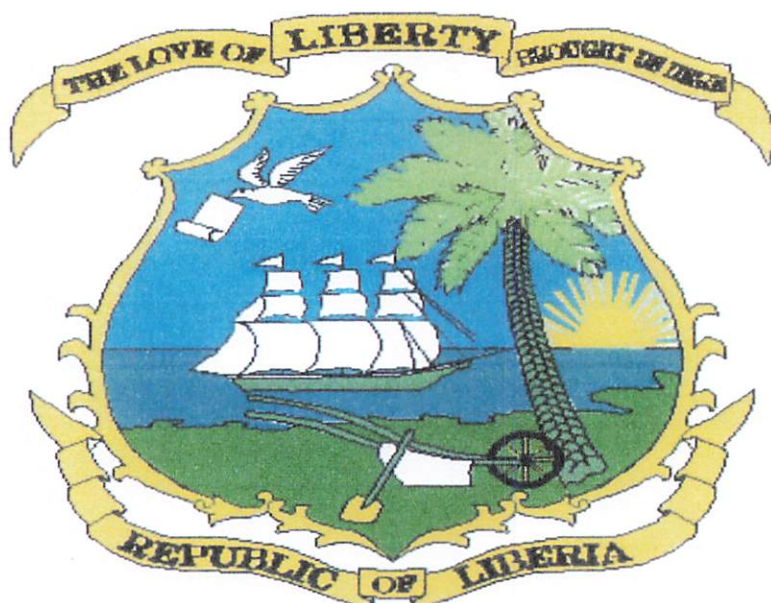
**“AN ACT TO REPEAL CHAPTER 25, MINISTRY OF
INTERNAL AFFAIRS, TITLE 12, EXECUTIVE LAW OF 1972,
LIBERIA CODE OF LAW REVISED TO ESTABLISH IN ITS
STEAD, A NEW CHAPTER 25, TO BE KNOWN AS THE
MINISTRY OF LOCAL GOVERNMENT”**

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MINISTRY OF FOREIGN AFFAIRS
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**AN ACT TO REPEAL CHAPTER 25, MINISTRY OF INTERNAL
AFFAIRS, TITLE 12, EXECUTIVE LAW OF 1972, LIBERIAN
CODES OF LAW REVISED, TO ESTABLISH IN ITS STEAD, A
NEW CHAPTER 25 TO BE KNOWN AS THE MINISTRY OF
LOCAL GOVERNMENT**



**PUBLISHED BY AUTHORITY OF THE MINISTRY OF
FOREIGN AFFAIRS**

DATE:

AN ACT TO REPEAL CHAPTER 25, MINISTRY OF INTERNAL AFFAIRS, TITLE 12, EXECUTIVE LAW OF 1972, LIBERIAN CODES OF LAW REVISED, TO ESTABLISH IN IT'S STEAD, A NEW CHAPTER 25 TO BE KNOWN AS THE MINISTRY OF LOCAL GOVERNMENT

WHEREAS, Chapter 10, Article 89 of the Liberian Constitution (1986) empowers the Legislature to enact statutes for the creation of ministries, agencies, commissions and autonomous bodies as may be necessary for the effective operation of the Government;

WHEREAS, Chapter 25, Executive Law of 1972, Titled 12, Liberian Codes of Law Revised, established the Ministry of Internal Affairs, which, among other things, is responsible to administer all aspects of local government including cultural practices and traditional values; and conduct the affairs of local government through regulation and coordination of the activities of the political subdivisions;

WHEREAS, the promulgation of the National Policy on Decentralization and Local Governance by the Government in 2011, and the subsequent enactment of the Local Government Act of 2018, and the Revenue Sharing Law of 2021, devolves certain political, administrative and fiscal powers and functions from the central government to county and sub-county authorities;

WHEREAS, Liberia desires to sustain peace, political stability and inclusive socio-economic development and promote national reconciliation, unification and integration amongst the citizens in their local communities and throughout the Republic;

WHEREAS, promulgation of the National Policy on Decentralization and Local Governance, the Local Government Act of 2018, and the Revenue Sharing Law of 2021 all impose new mandates and functions on the Ministry; and it has thereby become necessary to rename the Ministry, adjust its core mandates, functions and structure, and strengthen its capacity to effectively lead the implementation of laws, policies and programs in decentralization, peacebuilding and local government.

NOW, THEREFORE, it is enacted by the Senate and House of Representatives of the Republic of Liberia in Legislature assembled:

CHAPTER 25. MINISTRY OF LOCAL GOVERNMENT

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Chapter 1: GENERAL PROVISIONS

§25.1 Short Title

This Act shall be cited as the Ministry of Local Government

§25.2 Definitions

In this Act, unless otherwise required or unless a different definition is expressly provided in a given case, the following definitions shall apply:

Community: means a group of people residing closely together in the same locality or under the same village or town leadership.

Contract: means an agreement between the Ministry of Local Government and a vendor, an institution or an individual, creating obligations that are enforceable or otherwise recognizable at law or in equity.

Contractor: means one who has been hired to perform work or service for the Ministry of Local Government.

Collaborate: means working jointly with someone or institution to achieve a result.

Coordinate: means organization of the different elements of a complex body or activities so as to enable them to work together effectively.

Functions: mean and include every duty, authority and responsibility vested in the Ministry of Local Government and Peacebuilding, Minister, Deputy Ministers, and any agent or representative thereof.

Government: means the Government of the Republic of Liberia.

Incumbents: mean the current employees of the Ministry of Internal Affairs.

Minister: means the Minister of Local Government.

Ministry: means the Ministry of Local Government.

Local Government: means the administrative or governing body of a town, city, district, county, or region that provides public services to the area, governed by local officials.

Leadership: means the ability to guide, direct, lead or influence the work or behavior of others, a group or people towards the realization of a goal(s) or objectives.

Good Governance: means the process or management of government that respects the rights of citizens and follows the rule of law; it is participatory and inclusive, and ensures that the views of the minority as well as those of the most vulnerable in society are taken into consideration in major decision-making; it is transparent, accountable, and less open to abuse and corruption, and it respects the freedom of the press, provides equal access to justice, efficient and effective public service and upholds international norms and practices.

Central Government: means the political and administrative authority that governs the whole country and is concerned with national issues as opposed to local government which is concerned with a smaller area, it includes the legislative, the executive and the judicial branches of government, it makes and interprets laws for the whole country and has executive responsibilities for defense and national security, foreign affairs and regulation of international trade.

Nation: means the Republic of Liberia.

Rural: means remote places or localities removed from cities or urban areas.

Peacebuilding: means processes and activities that prevent or reduce risks of or avoid relapse into conflict; improve conflict management and promote reconciliation, unification and integration; and lay foundations for social cohesion, sustainable peace and development and political stability.

Transferred Employees means current employees of the Ministry of Internal Affairs who may become employees of the Ministry of Local Government and Peacebuilding upon the coming into force of this Act.

§25.3 Objective

The Objective of this Act is to repeal the Act establishing the Ministry of Internal Affairs and to create and establish in its stead the Ministry of Local Government consistent with the Local Government Act of 2018; to give effect to and implement the provisions of the Local government Act which devolves more power and authority to local governments and enables more participation of citizens and local authorities in the governance of the country.

§25.4 Validity of Prior Actions of the Ministry of Internal Affairs

Notwithstanding the repeal of the aforementioned Chapter 25 and all Acts and Executive Orders amendatory thereto, any contract, order, decision or anything made or done by the Ministry of Internal Affairs before the coming into force of this Act which was duly authorized in keeping with the repealed and amended Acts and Executive

Orders shall be valid and continue to be in full force and effect as if made or done under this Act.

§25.5: Repeals and Amendments

- a) Chapter 25 Ministry of Internal Affairs, Title 12, Liberian Code of Laws Revised, is hereby repealed and replaced with a new Chapter 25 of the same title. All of its mandate and functions are hereby transferred to the Ministry of Local Government in keeping with this Act;
- b) Chapter 31, Section 31.5, Bureau of Culture, Ministry of Information, Culture Affairs and Tourism is hereby repealed and all cultural functions appertaining to that Ministry or Bureau have been transferred to the Ministry of Local Government.

§25.6 Establishment of the Ministry

It is hereby established in the Executive Branch of the Government, the Ministry of Local Government which shall be Title 12, New Executive Law of Liberia, Liberian Code of Laws Revised and hereafter referred to as the Ministry.

§25.7 Mandate of the Ministry

The Ministry shall be responsible for providing executive oversight of local governments, specifically in their: management of balanced, socio-economic development programs, empowerment of local communities, strengthening the delivery of social services, and the promotion and delivery of good governance, including popular participation, inclusiveness, transparency, accountability, and access to justice at local levels. It shall be responsible also for providing executive oversight of peacebuilding, promotion of reconciliation, social cohesion, and national unification and integration to ensure sustainable peace, development and political stability.

§25.8 Functions of the Ministry

The Ministry's core functions shall be to:

- a. Administer all laws and regulations relating to local government, decentralization, and peacebuilding.
- b. Formulate policies and programs that reinforce, support, and strengthen citizens' participation in local governance decision-making.

- c. Develop regulations and policies, including gender mainstreaming, to ensure effective implementation of the National Policy on Decentralization and Local Governance, the Local Government Act of 2018, and the Revenue Sharing Law of 2021.**
- d. Lead in the implementation of laws, policies and programs on decentralization and local government, including the Local Government Act of 2018 and Revenue Sharing Law of 2021, all of which democratize governance and decentralize the machinery of government;**
- e. Build capacity of personnel of the Ministry and of the local county and municipal governments through training in decentralization, and local government; and technical, managerial and leadership training to support efficient service delivery to citizens nation-wide.**
- f. Conduct conflict mapping research, formulate policies and programs that prevent or reduce risks of, or relapse into conflict, and strengthen conflict management; promote reconciliation and integration; and lay foundations for social cohesion, sustainable peace, political stability and national development.**
- g. Ensure the strengthening of local government capacities, including institutional systems and structures; human resource capacities, at all levels of local governments (district, chiefdom, clan, and general town as well as in cities and townships);**
- h. Serve as the principal linkage between local governments and central government ministries, agencies, and autonomous bodies and commissions;**
- i. Monitor and evaluate the effectiveness of local government and peacebuilding activities to ensure that they are responsive to the needs of the people;**
- j. Ensure compliance with the Constitution and laws of Liberia; and with international instruments to which Liberia is a party or has acceded;**
- k. Regulate public sanitation in all villages, towns and cities including regulating garbage disposal dumpsites, operation of funeral parlors, burials and maintenance of grave sites and graves.**

- l. Research, analyze, advocate and formulate policies on relevant local government and peacebuilding issues, including those related to mobilizing and harnessing communities and local resources for local social cohesion and development;
- m. Manage administrative support equipment and services, including financial management, human resources, information systems, transportation and communications, power and water, procurement, security, and maintenance.
- n. Coordinate activities of central government ministries and agencies in their implementation of so-economic and infrastructural development programs in the counties.
- o. Provide oversight and coordinate the activities of the National council of Chiefs, and all county and municipal governments to preserve, protect and promote positive Liberian traditions, cultures, cultural heritage and institutions.
- p. Coordinate with relevant institutions of government to identify, harmonize and resolve boundary disputes nation-wide;
- q. Mainstream gender in local county and municipal governments consistent with Section 6.1 of the Local Government Act of 2018;
- r. Research, analyze, formulate policies on local government issues including those related to mobilizing and harnessing communities and local resources for local development and social cohesion;
- s. Perform such other functions as may be directed by the President of Liberia consistent with the Constitution.

§25.9 Structure of the Ministry

Each department of the Ministry shall be composed of divisions, sections, and units dedicated to implementing the mandates and functions of the Ministry. The organization and structure of the Ministry is as follows:

The Ministry:

a. Office of the Minister

The office of the Minister shall provide executive leadership, strategic policy direction, oversight, and guidance to the Ministry.

b. Offices of Deputy Ministers

The offices of Deputy Ministers shall assist the Office of the Minister in providing administrative oversight and policy direction to functional areas of the ministry.

c. Offices of Assistant Ministers

The offices of Assistant Ministers shall assist the offices of Deputy Ministers in providing research-based, policy-level technical support and managerial direction of the functional divisions of the Ministry.

d. Sections and Units of the Ministry

The sections and units of the Ministry shall assist the offices of the Minister, Deputy Ministers and Assistant Ministers in the performance of their duties. They shall perform a variety of technical support tasks including research, providing technical IT support maintaining the Ministry's computer-based information and technology systems; performing administrative and clerical support work to the development of annual work plans and budgets, report writing, program monitoring and evaluation; and performing rotational assignments in the delivery of quality and efficient services to the public.

The Departments:

The following shall constitute the departments of the Ministry:

a. Department for Local Government and Decentralization

The Department for Local Government and Decentralization shall direct administration of local government affairs, and the implementation of decentralization programs. The department shall formulate policies, regulations and programs for promotion of good governance in county and municipal governments; oversee implementation of functions devolved or delegated to counties by the central government; supervise planning and implementation of development programs including provision of public services such as housing, utilities, water and sanitation, waste management, transport, zoning and spatial management of local areas; collaborate with sectoral authorities in agriculture, education, health, gender and social protection; and ensure collaboration of local authorities with national security surveillance mechanisms in local areas; and ensure implementation of policies and programs are in line with the general policy direction of the Government.

b. Department for Administration

The Department of Administration shall be responsible for the provision of legal, policy and administrative support services for the implementation of the Ministry's programs; provide regular legal guidance and advice; coordinate implementation of administrative policies, regulations and programs; manage the Ministry's finances including the budget, collecting and reporting on financial data; developing and updating reporting template for use by county and municipal governments; supervise preparation of the

Ministry's annual reports; collaborate with Local Government Fiscal Board in development and operation of revenue management systems and distribution of revenues between county and municipal authorities; coordinate the Ministry's resource mobilization strategy; manage the Ministry's human resources including recruitment, employment, training, evaluation and rewarding or dismissal of employees; ensure employees adhere to the organizational culture of the Ministry, and the Civil Service Standing Orders, rules and regulations; and adhere to the Code of Conduct for All Public Officials and Employees of Liberia; and ensure implementation of policies and programs are in line with the general policy direction of the Government.

c. Department for Research, Policy, and Planning

The Department of Research, Policy, and Planning shall be responsible for conducting high quality research and publishing findings on all issues affecting matters relating to all departments of the Ministry, and to county and municipal governments nation-wide; produce research reports in the Ministry's annual research journal; responsible for research and policy development, promotion of history and culture of the nation's diverse ethnic groups; preservation of cultural and historical materials; lead development of policies and regulations; conduct monitoring and evaluation of services to the counties; articulate the Ministry's mission and vision; lead development of the Ministry's medium and long-term strategic plans, and annual work plans; coordinate planning and implementation of the ministry's programs; Responsible for research and policy development, promotion of history and culture of the nation's diverse ethnic groups, preservation of historical materials; develop programs in development planning and provide guidance to counties and municipalities; and ensure implementation of policies and programs are in line with the general policy direction of the Government.

d. Department for Urban Affairs

This department shall be headed by a Deputy Minister who shall be supported by an Assistant Minister consistent with this Act. Together they shall provide policy directives and support for the management and development of urban centers at the national, regional and local levels including capital cities, secondary cities, townships and other defined urban locales; improve urban planning policies, improve coordination of established urban areas and strengthen the implementation of planning practices to achieve prosperous urban centers in Liberia.

§25.10 Appointment and Duties of the Minister of Local Government

There shall be appointment by the President, with the advice and consent of the Senate, a Minister of Local Government, who shall serve as Chief Executive Officer of the Ministry. He/she shall have responsibility to provide executive leadership, strategic policy direction, oversight, and guidance to the Ministry; and to ensure the effective and efficient implementation of the mandate and core functions of the Ministry. The Minister shall be assisted by Deputy Ministers who shall report to him/her.
The duties of the Minister shall be as follows:

- a. Advise the President on all issues relating to local government and decentralization;
- b. Under authority and powers delegated to him/her by the President, provide executive oversight of local governments, tribal and traditional affairs;
- c. Provide effective leadership to the ministry, including evolving a vision, mission, and developing core values consistent with the mandate of the ministry;
- d. Prepare and defend the Ministry's annual program and its related expenditure budget proposals;
- e. Develop the human resource capacity of the Ministry to enable workers implement their functions effectively and efficiently;
- f. Mobilize resources, in consultation and collaboration with the relevant government institutions, to augment technical and financial resources annually available to the Ministry;
- g. Submit to the President and the Legislature, not later than 30 days at the end of each calendar year, an Annual Report of the activities and operations of the Ministry during the preceding year;
- h. Chair the Inter-Ministerial Committee on Decentralization and Local Government (IMCDLG);
- i. Perform such other duties that are incidental to being the Minister of Local Government and
- j. Perform duties the President may from time to time assign to the office of the Minister.

§25.11 Appointment of Deputy Ministers

The President, with the advice and consent of the Senate, shall appoint the following Deputy Ministers, each of whom shall be head of a Department within the Ministry:

- a. Deputy Minister for Local Government & Decentralization
- b. Deputy Minister for Research, Policy and Planning
- c. Deputy Minister for Urban Affairs
- d. Deputy Minister for Administration

§25.12 Functions of the Deputy Minister for Local Government & Decentralization

The Deputy Minister for Local Government & Decentralization shall be the principal deputy to the Minister and shall have oversight of the ministry's role in the administration of local government affairs, and the implementation of decentralization programs consistent with the Local Government Act and the Revenue Sharing Law. The duties of the Deputy Minister for Local Government and Decentralization shall be as follows:

- a. Oversee implementation of decentralization and local government laws; coordinate implementation of political, administrative and fiscal decentralization programs and related regulations; and lead formulation of policies and plans for promotion of good governance in county and municipal governments.
- b. Supervise planning and implementation of development programs including provision of public services such as housing, utilities, water and sanitation, waste management, transport, zoning and spatial management of local areas;
- c. Lead development and sourcing of training programs in administrative and fiscal decentralization, development planning, and local governance; provide training and capacity building for the Ministry and for all units of county and municipal governments.
- d. Facilitate operations of the National Council of Chiefs in the administration of the Council's mandates, and programs; and the administration of tribal and traditional affairs.

- e. Supervise planning and implementation of development programs for provision of local government services such as housing, utilities, water and sanitation, waste management, transport, zoning and spatial management of local areas.
- f. Assist local county and municipal governments to organize the institutions, structures and systems outlined in the Local Government Act; Oversee implementation of functions devolved or delegated to counties by the central government; collaborate with Local Government Fiscal Board in development and operation of revenue management systems and distribution of revenues between county and municipal authorities.
- g. Prepare and implement Information, Education and Communication (IEC) Programs on the implementation national decentralization programs; lead sustained decentralization advocacy work.
- h. Collaborate with sectoral authorities in agriculture, education, health, gender and social protection, and revenue administration in planning and implementation of their sector decentralization programs in the counties.
- i. Lead periodic assessment, monitoring and evaluation of the overall national decentralization program outlining achievements, challenges and future prospects; collaborate in the preparation of the Ministry's quarterly and annual reports.
- j. Ensure collaboration of all county and municipal officials and chiefs with national security surveillance mechanisms in the counties, cities, towns and local areas.
- k. Perform such other duties that are incidental to being the Deputy Minister for Local Government & Decentralization; and
- l. Perform duties the Minister may assign to the Office of Deputy Minister for Local Government & Decentralization.

§25.13: Functions of the Deputy Minister for Administration

The Deputy Minister for Administration shall have oversight of the Ministry's technical, fiscal and administrative support services. The duties of the Deputy Minister for Administration shall be as follows:

- a. Administer financial management systems and services, including budgeting, petty cash management, financial accounting and reporting, internal and external audits; and ensuring that they are consistent with the public financial management law and regulations; coordinate the Ministry's resource mobilization strategy; provide legal

guidance and advice in implementation of administrative policies, regulations and programs.

- b. Manage the Ministry's human resources including recruitment, employment, training, evaluation and rewarding or dismissal of employees; ensure employees adhere to the organizational culture of the Ministry, and the Civil Service Standing Orders, rules and regulations; and adhere to the Code of Conduct for All Public Officials and Employees of Liberia.
- c. Administer collection and reporting of financial data; develop and update a reporting template for use by county and municipal governments; supervise preparation of the Ministry's annual reports; manage procurement of goods, supplies, works and consulting services ensuring that they are consistent with the laws and regulations of the Public Procurement and Concessions Commission;
- d. Manage the ministry's general services as such warehousing and accessing of goods and supplies; transportation and communication; power and water systems; security and maintenance, ensuring that procedures are consistent with policies and vfreulations of the General Services Agency;
- e. Perform such other duties that are incidental to being the Deputy Minister for Administration of the Ministry; and
- f. Perform duties the Minister may from time to time assign to the Office of the Deputy Minister for Administration.

§25.14 Functions of the Deputy Minister for Research, Policy and Planning

The Deputy Minister for Research, Policy and Planning shall have oversight of the Ministry's activities in research, policy formulation, development planning, monitoring and evaluation and the responsibility of the Ministry's development planning functions for local governments across the country. He/she shall be responsible for conducting high quality policy research activities nation-wide; and publishing findings on all matters relating to administration of county and municipal governance, decentralization, peacebuilding, and cultural and traditional affairs. The duties of the Deputy Minister for Research, Policy and Planning shall be as follows:

- a. Manage methods and procedures involved in conducting research, and publishing findings on all issues affecting matters relating to all departments of the Ministry, and to county and municipal governments nation-wide.

- b. Supervise processes involved in public policy development and promulgating national policies, regulations and guidelines relating to all aspects of the Ministry's core functions.
- c. Lead the Ministry's development planning functions and activities including plans for reorganizing municipalities including new design of organizational structure; and development of physical infrastructures for orderly growth of municipalities, districts, chiefdoms, clans and towns.
- d. Promote history and culture of the nation's diverse ethnic groups and lead advocacy for preservation of cultural and historical materials and artifacts.
- e. Develop and maintain data bank of information on local governments and local government activities within the country; establish and maintain an effective local government management information and communications system;
- f. Manage the Ministry's monitoring and evaluation system and programs, ensuring they adhere to national laws, policies and regulations;
- g. Coordinate the preparation of Annual Reports to the President and Legislature;
- h. Assist the Minister in sourcing resources for local governments; develop and coordinate of donor relations; prepare project proposals and engage donors for possible access to external funding resources to assist local governments.
- i. Lead the Ministry's boundary harmonization program; collaborate with other government agencies and institutions to harmonize boundaries nation-wide and develop a national cadastral for Liberia.
- j. Perform such other duties that are incidental to being the Deputy Minister for Research, Policy and Planning; and
- k. Perform duties the Minister may assign to the office of Deputy Minister for Research, Policy and Planning.

§25.15 Functions of the Deputy Minister for Urban Affairs

The Deputy Minister for Urban Affairs under the direction of the Minister, shall have oversight of the Ministry's activities in the domains of technical services and urban affairs. The duties of the Deputy Minister for Urban Affairs shall be as follow:

- a) Develop national policies, regulations and guidelines for effective urban development and management to promote sustainable and equitable development of urban communities nationwide;
- b) Provide technical assistance and capacity development to local governments to develop strategic plans, zoning codes, ordinances, and other development controls for the planned growth of urban locales including cities, towns and boroughs;
- c) Collaborate with the relevant agencies of government responsible for land administration to ensure harmonization and demarcation of local government boundaries;
- d) Manage the process of assessment and re-affirmation of municipalities (cities and townships);
- e) Support local governments to develop and strengthen municipal management and administration to include developing standard operating procedures (SOPs), processes and systems for efficient service delivery;
- f) Monitor and evaluate the implementation of spatial and strategic development plans at the local level to enhance service delivery, municipal management and administration; and
- a) Perform duties that the Minister may, from time to time, assign to the Office of the Deputy Minister for Urban Affairs.

§25.16: Appointment of Assistant Ministers

The President, with the consent of the Senate, shall appoint the following Assistant Ministers, each of whom shall serve a Department within the Ministry:

- a. Assistant Minister for Local Government & Decentralization
- b. Assistant Minister for Research, Policy and Planning
- c. Assistant Minister for Urban Affairs
- d. Assistant Minister for Administration
- e. Assistant Minister for Legal Affairs and Traditional Marriages
- f. Assistant Minister for Culture and Tradition

§25.17: Functions of Assistant Minister for Local Government and Decentralization

The Assistant Minister for Local Government & Decentralization shall provide policy-level administrative support to the Deputy Minister in the administration of local government affairs, and the implementation of decentralization programs. The duties of the Assistant Minister for Local Government and Decentralization shall be as follow:

- m. Provide technical support in the development and implementation of programs and projects in political, administrative and fiscal decentralization; advocate promotion of good governance in county and municipal governments.
- n. Assist in establishment of local municipal organizations and structures including treasury facilities; outline process of sourcing revenues; establish and update roster of minimum services to be provided in city, township and the Borough of New Kru Town.
- o. Develop, update and circulate roster for functions devolved to local governments; advocate for corresponding finances for implementation of functions delegated to local governments.
- p. Lead funding advocacy and efforts for sourcing resources for local governments; initiate and foster donor relations; prepare project proposals and engage donors for possible access to external funding to assist local governments.
- q. Lead development and implementation of career development training programs for county and municipal officers and employees in areas of revenue administration, waste management, city planning, water and sanitation, zoning, etc.; source training opportunities in legislative work for members of county and municipal councils nation-wide.
- r. Assist operations of the National Council of Chiefs in the administration of the Council's mandate, functions and programs; and the administration of tribal and traditional affairs.
- s. Assist in preparation of department's strategic plans, annual work plans; assessment, and monitoring and evaluation of department's programs; drafting and circulation of policies and regulations; and preparation of quarterly and annual reports.
- t. Perform such other duties that are incidental to being the Assistant Minister for Local Government & Decentralization; and

- u. Perform duties the Deputy Minister may assign to the Office of Assistant Minister for Local Government & Decentralization.

§25.18: Functions of Assistant Minister for Administration

The Assistant Minister for Administration shall provide policy-level administrative support to provide technical, fiscal and administrative services to the Ministry. The duties of the Assistant Minister for Administration shall be as follow:

- a. Support the Ministry's fiscal management system, including budgeting, petty cash management, financial accounting and reporting, internal and external audits; and ensure that they are consistent with the public financial management laws and regulations.
- b. Assist in development and application of guidelines, regulations and procedures for procurement of goods and services; and ensure that they are consistent with the laws and regulations of the Public Procurement and Concessions Commission.
- c. Provide administrative support to human resources management including development of recruitment guidelines, recruiting, selection, training, and retention, ensuring that they are consistent with civil service law, policies and regulations.
- d. Support general services including warehousing and accessing of goods and supplies; transportation, communication and technology; power and water systems; security and maintenance; ensure they are consistent with policies and regulations of the General Services Agency;
- e. Collaborate in advocacy for funding support for local governments; initiate and foster donor relations; assist in preparation of project proposals and engaging donors for possible access to external funding.
- f. Perform such other duties that are incidental to being the Assistant Minister for Administration; and
- g. Perform duties the Minister may from time to time assign to the Office of the Assistant Minister for Administration

§25.19: Functions of Assistant Minister for Research, Policy and Planning

The Assistant Minister for Research, Policy and Planning shall provide policy-level research, planning and policy support to assist the Deputy Minister. The duties of the Assistant Minister for Research, Policy and Planning shall be as follow:

- a. Assist in research, policy and planning work; establish methods and procedures for conducting research, and publishing findings on all issues affecting matters relating to all departments of the Ministry, county and municipal governments.
- b. Supervise processes involved in public policy development and promulgation of national policies, regulations and guidelines relating to all aspects of the Ministry's mandate and core functions.
- c. Assist in development planning, programs and activities including plans for reorganizing and strengthening operations of municipalities such as treasury and financing arrangements, and development of infrastructures for orderly growth of municipalities, districts, chiefdoms, clans and towns.
- d. Assist in activities for preservation of the history and culture of the nation's diverse ethnic groups; and lead advocacy for preservation of culture and for conservation of cultural and historical sites, materials and artifacts.
- e. Assist in establishment of effective local government management information and communications technology system; develop and maintain information platform on local governments and local government activities nation-wide.
- f. Lead processes of conducting research and preparing reports; assist in preparation of the Ministry's budget, annual work plans, and reports on monitoring and evaluation of programs.
- g. Lead advocacy for sourcing resources for local governments; initiate and foster donor relations; prepare project proposals and engage donors for possible access to external funding to assist local governments.
- h. Assist in the boundary harmonization program; collaborate with other government agencies and institutions to harmonize boundaries nation-wide and develop a national cadastral for Liberia.
- i. Perform such other duties that are incidental to being Assistant Minister for Research, Policy and Planning; and
- j. Perform duties the Minister may assign to the office of Assistant Minister for Research, Policy and Planning.

§25.20: Functions of Assistant Minister for Urban Affairs

The Assistant Minister for Urban Affairs shall:

- a) Assist the Deputy Minister for Urban Affairs in the execution of his/her duties; and
- b) Perform all other duties that may be assigned by the Deputy Minister for Urban Affairs.

§25.21: Functions of Assistant Minister for Legal Affairs and Traditional Mariages

The Assistant Minister for Legal Affairs and Traditional Marriages shall provide policy-level legal services support to all departments of the Ministry including the administration of cultural and traditional marriages. The duties of the Assistant Minister for Legal Affairs and Traditional Marriages shall be as follow:

- a. Assist the Ministry in reviewing existing legislation, rules and regulations related to the mandate and functions of the Ministry, operations of various departments and recommending appropriate legal advice.
- b. Provide advice on legal matters, review and/or draft legal documents such as contracts, lease agreements; conduct legal research and interpret legal implications of laws, policies, rules and regulations.
- c. Serve as legal professional overseeing all legal matters in the Ministry including administration of cultural and traditional marriages. Conduct cultural and traditional marriages and issue traditional marriage certificates.
- d. Conduct traditional marriage/divorce court; investigate and establish validity of claims in traditional marriages.
- e. Perform such other duties that are incidental to being the Assistant Minister for Legal Affairs and Traditional Marriages; and
- f. Perform duties the Minister may from time to time assign to the Office of the Assistant Minister for Legal Affairs and Traditional Marriages.

§25.22. Functions of the Assistant Minister for Culture and Tradition

The Assistant Minister for Cultural Affairs shall be responsible to:

§25.22. Functions of the Assistant Minister for Culture and Tradition

The Assistant Minister for Cultural Affairs shall be responsible to:

- a) Direct, supervise, coordinate and manage all cultural matters in Liberia;
- b) Advance, preserve, promote and protect positive Liberian cultural heritage through the organization and implementation of programs; and
- c) Perform all other duties that may be assigned by the Deputy Minister for Local Government and Decentralization.

§25.22: Transitional Provisions

Upon the effective date of this Act, the following actions shall be considered automatically taken:

- a. The person serving as Minister of Internal Affairs prior to the coming into effect of this Act shall serve as Minister of Local Government pending the appointment by the President with the consent of the Senate.
- b. Deputy and Assistant Ministers already serving prior to the coming into effect of this Act shall continue to serve until appointments are made by the President with the consent of the Senate.
- c. All assets and liabilities legally acquired by the Ministry of Internal Affairs shall be transferred to the Ministry of Local Government. This shall include contract rights and obligations. The remaining budget of the Ministry of Internal Affairs shall be automatically transferred to the Ministry of Local Government.
- d. The officers and employees of the Ministry of Internal Affairs shall, in a holdover capacity, continue to perform their respective duties and responsibilities to and receive the corresponding salaries and benefits until the new position structure and staffing pattern of the Ministry shall be prescribed by the Minister in keeping with the Civil Service policy and regulations.

§25.23: EFFECTIVE DATE

This Act shall take effect immediately upon publication in Handbills by the Ministry of Foreign Affairs.

ANY ACT TO THE CONTRARY NOTWITHSTANDING

-2025-

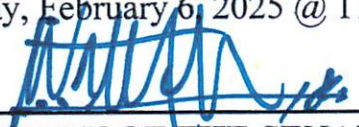
SECOND SESSION OF THE FIFTY-FIFTH
LEGISLATURE OF THE REPUBLIC OF LIBERIA

SENATE'S ENGROSSED BILL NO: 5 ENTITLED:

**"AN ACT TO REPEAL CHAPTER 25,
MINISTRY OF INTERNAL AFFAIRS, TITLE 12,
EXECUTIVE LAW OF 1972, LIBERIA CODE OF
LAW REVISED TO ESTABLISH IN ITS STEAD,
A NEW CHAPTER 25, TO BE KNOWN AS THE
MINISTRY OF LOCAL GOVERNMENT"**

On motion, Bill read on its 1st reading, Tuesday, April 30, 2024 @ 13:38 GMT. On motion Bill read on its second reading, adopted and send to the Committee Room on Tuesday, May 7, 2024 at 12:50 GMT.

On motion, Bill taken from the Committee Room. On motion under the suspension of the rule, the third reading of the Bill constituted the third and final reading and the Bill was adopted, passed into the full force of the law and ordered engrossed today, Thursday, February 6, 2025 @ 11:57 G.M.T.



SECRETARY OF THE SENATE, R.L

-2025-

SECOND SESSION OF THE FIFTY-FIFTH LEGISLATURE
OF THE REPUBLIC OF LIBERIA

HOUSE'S ENDORSEMENT TO SENATE ENGROSSED BILL
NO. 5 ENTITLED:

**"AN ACT TO REPEAL CHAPTER 25, MINISTRY OF INTERNAL
AFFAIRS, TITLE 12, AND EXECUTIVE LAW OF 1972, LIBERIA
CODE OF LAW REVISED TO ESTABLISH IN ITS STEAD, A NEW
CHAPTER 25, TO BE KNOWN AS THE MINISTRY OF LOCA
GOVERNMENT"**

On Motion Bill was read. On Motion, the Bill was adopted on its first reading and sent to Committee Room on Thursday, February 13, 2025 @ 13:14 GMT.

On motion, Bill taken from the Committee Room. On motion under the suspension of the rule, the second reading of the Bill constituted the third and final reading and the Bill was adopted, passed into the full force of the law and ordered engrossed today, Thursday, June 24, 2025 @ 13:30 GMT.



CHIEF CLERK, HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES



SECRETARY OF THE SENATE



The Liberian Senate

CAPITOL BUILDING, CAPITOL HILL, MONROVIA, LIBERIA
WEST AFRICA

-2025-

SECOND SESSION OF THE FIFTY-FIFTH LEGISLATURE OF THE REPUBLIC OF
LIBERIA

SCHEDULE OF SENATE'S ENROLLED BILL NO. 3 ENTITLED:

AN ACT TO REPEAL CHAPTER 25, MINISTRY OF INTERNAL
AFFAIRS, TITLE 12, EXECUTIVE LAW OF 1972, LIBERIA CODE OF
LAW REVISED TO ESTABLISH IN ITS STEAD, A NEW CHAPTER 25,
TO BE KNOWN AS THE MINISTRY OF LOCAL GOVERNMENT

PRESENTED TO THE PRESIDENT OF THE REPUBLIC OF LIBERIA FOR
EXECUTIVE APPROVAL

APPROVED THIS 28th DAY OF July A.D. 2025

AT THE HOUR OF 3:30 PM



THE PRESIDENT OF THE REPUBLIC OF LIBERIA